Continuous fluorouracil + radiotherapy

Continuous fluorouracil helps radiotherapy treat locally advanced rectal cancer. Your team explains how this fits with surgery and other treatment.

Locally advanced rectal cancer · NCCP 00421 v6 · Document revised 4 November 2026

Your personal plan: this is the standard regimen schedule. Your team confirms your prescribed doses, cycles, treatment changes and appointments in your written plan.

My overall treatment

Fluorouracil runs continuously through a pump, seven days a week, during a six-week radiotherapy course. The pump is changed every seven days. Radiotherapy has its own appointment calendar.

7 day view

Treatment timing in this window

Treatment pattern Day 1–7

Treatment

Fluorouracil runs continuously through a pump, seven days a week, during a six-week radiotherapy course. The pump is changed every seven days. Radiotherapy has its own appointment calendar.

Review and next steps

Your team confirms recovery, response, course length and follow-up; changes need a revised written plan.

Your treatment schedule

Day 1	Days 1-7	Radiotherapy
Review and connect or change pump	Continuous infusion, including weekends	Attend the separate radiation schedule

Your team confirms the active phase and dates. Symptoms may occur during or after treatment; there are no guaranteed safe days.

My tests and checks

When	What is checked	Timing / reason
Before	**dihydropyrimidine dehydrogenase (a medicine-processing enzyme) (DPD) and baseline bloods** Required by regimen	Confirm DPD testing, blood count, kidney and liver results before starting.
During	**Blood count / kidneys / liver** Required by regimen	Weekly throughout treatment. Review symptoms before treatment.
After / review	**Recovery, scans / markers** Team-agreed plan	Follow the individual cancer plan; this regimen does not prescribe a universal scan or marker interval.

Between treatments

- Report fever, sudden illness, diarrhoea, mouth pain or poor intake promptly.
- Symptoms can occur during treatment, between visits and after completion.

Confirm your prescription, supportive medicines, tests and working contact numbers.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.

What to watch for

You do not need to know which medicine caused a symptom before calling.

1 Mouth / eating

Fluorouracil

Report painful ulcers or difficulty eating and drinking.

2 Chest / heart

Fluorouracil

New chest pain needs urgent assessment, including during an infusion.

3 Bowel / hydration

Fluorouracil + pelvic radiotherapy

Report diarrhoea, increased stoma output, severe pain, blood or dehydration.

4 Hands / feet

Fluorouracil

Report painful redness, cracking or peeling that affects daily activity.

5 Blood / infection

Chemotherapy

Fever, shivers or sudden illness need immediate oncology advice.

6 Pump / line

Fluorouracil delivery

Report leakage, line pain, swelling, disconnection or a stopped pump immediately.

7 Pelvic skin / bladder

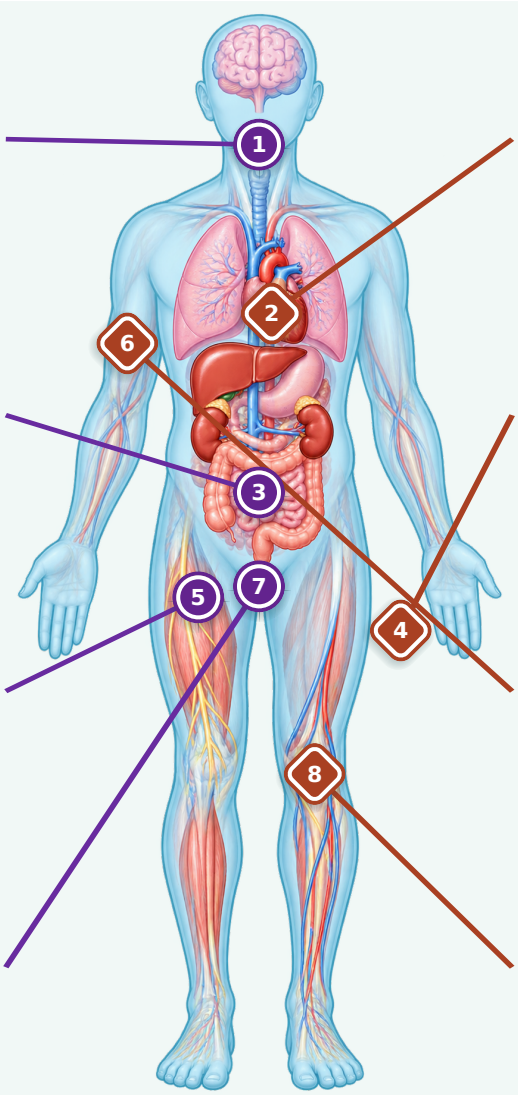
Radiotherapy

Report skin pain, urinary symptoms or bleeding; effects can continue after treatment.

8 Recovery / daily life

Chemoradiotherapy

Tell the team if tiredness, pain or poor intake limits normal activities.



Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Contact oncology immediately for fever, shivering, sudden illness, severe diarrhoea, inability to drink, very little urine or unusual bleeding. New severe chest pain, collapse or major breathing difficulty needs emergency help.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

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Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.

Keep your treatment details to hand

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Print this page **one-sided on A4 at Actual size / 100%**. Cut only the dashed outer border around both panels. **Do not cut the centre line.** Fold with FRONT and BACK facing out, then glue or tape the blank backs together. Finished size: **85.6 × 54 mm**. Keep the stamp side writable.

FRONT / CONTACTS

My Treatment Card

SACTCheck

Name: _____

Continuous fluorouracil + radiotherapy

Continuous 7-day pump; change weekly during 6-week RT.

Phase: _____ Planned weekly doses: 6

Daytime (EXAMPLE) 087 12345678

Out of hours (EXAMPLE) 087 87654321

Unwell or fever? Call oncology now.
Severe breathing difficulty, chest pain or collapse: **112 / 999.**

EXAMPLE NUMBERS — replace before patient use.

CUT outer border

BACK / TREATMENT RECORD

My treatment record

Team stamps after each completed treatment.

W1	W2	W3
Date / initials	Date / initials	Date / initials
W4	**W5**	**W6**
Date / initials	Date / initials	Date / initials

My treatment information

Plan changed? Ask the team to update this card.

FOLD centre — do not cut

Keep the record accurate

The team dates and initials each recorded treatment unit when complete. A cycle is complete after its final planned dose; a weekly-treatment stamp records that weekly dose. Delays, omitted doses or a changed plan need a note or a replacement card. A stamp does not approve the next treatment. Keep any medicine-specific alert card too.

Put your treatment page on your phone

Scan your QR and check the treatment name. Save that page to your home screen.

iPhone / Safari

Tap Share → Add to Home Screen. Select Open as Web App if offered, then Add.

Android / Chrome

Tap the three-dot menu → Add to Home screen or Install and create shortcut. Choose the shortcut option and confirm.

Menu wording varies. The QR opens information, not a personal record. Paper stamps do not update the website. Check that the saved icon opens the correct treatment.

Your local contacts and resources

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Hospital / team: _____
Backup if the team cannot be reached: _____

Additional local services and resources will be added when confirmed. Your team must check and complete this page before patient use.